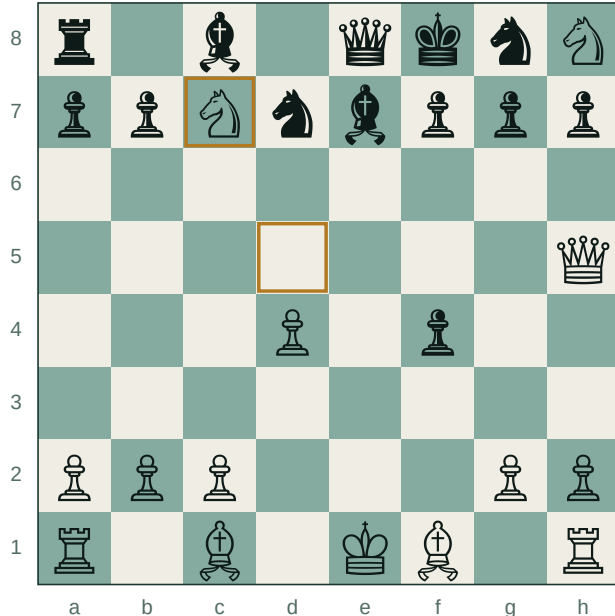


Double checks: Black, move 13

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Nxc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Bh4+ 14. Kd2 Qe3+ 15. Kd1 Qe1#

13...Bh4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on e8 attacks the king on e1. Recorded reply: **14.Kd2**.

14...Qe3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **15.Kd1**.

15...Qe1# Mate: queen on e1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on d1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on e1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: knight on h8 and knight on c7. Check for tactical protection.